

COVENANT OF THE CINDER-WROUGHT AEGIS AND THE STORMMARCH STANDARD

Let this sealed writing stand before ash-stone, and the watching silence, concerning The Cinder-Wrought Aegis, Stormmarch, and Castellan Fellgard.

I. OF THE AEGIS

The Cinder-Wrought Aegis shall be named regalia, and not coin, weapon, ransom, or common spoil. It is shaped by the legacy of the Sundering, and its purpose is bound to authority, ceremony, and the burden of ash-marked rule.

Whoever bears, wears, unveils, or places it beneath a standard shall do so with due austerity. Its cinder-dark surfaces, suggesting fire-scarred craftsmanship, shall not be polished into brightness or altered to lessen the severity of its making. No hand shall claim that the Aegis grants a crown, a command, or a right beyond the authority expressly spoken over it. Its atmosphere is one of sovereignty endured beneath ruin; let no claimant mistake endurance for triumph.

II. OF STORMMARCH

Stormmarch lies in the Ash Wastes and was founded in 71 AS. Its garrison numbers 9,263. These matters shall be entered without embellishment, lest a boast become a breach.

Stormmarch remains quarantined and outside the realm's core holdings. No bearer of this covenant shall treat its walls as open road, its garrison as a summoned host, or its sealed condition as void merely because the Aegis is present. The stronghold is a fortified settlement shaped by the harsh, ash-laden character of the Ash Wastes: sealed away, severe, and holding its military strength beneath quarantine.

The Aegis may be displayed there only under the terms of this writing and only in a manner that does not deny Stormmarch's quarantine or its position outside the realm's core holdings.

III. OF CASTELLAN FELLGARD

Castellan Fellgard, a minor figure of the Ashen Era, was born in 237 AS. He serves as a standard-bearer. His proper mark in this covenant

shall therefore be the standard he bears, not any likeness of his face or body. No canonical physical details are recorded for Castellan Fellgard, and none shall be supplied by wax, paint, rumor, or testimony.

His temperament is likewise unrecorded. No party shall construe silence in the record as gentleness, treachery, courage, or fear.

IV. SEALING

The parties shall preserve the Aegis, respect Stormmarch's quarantine, and recognize Castellan Fellgard by his office as standard-bearer. Any alteration, substitution, or false proclamation shall void the claim of the hand that makes it.

Set down beneath ash. Sealed without flourish.

Mark of the Holder: _____

Mark of the Standard-Bearer: _____

Witness Mark: _____